

Co-Executive Director for Aquatic Animal Policy Org

A Note on Anonymity: Due to the nature of our policy work, this job description has been anonymized to protect our active legislative campaigns from industry watchdogs. Candidates who advance past the initial application review will be provided with our full organizational identity, website, and specific policy targets so you can evaluate us as much as we evaluate you.

The Opportunity: Every year, billions of aquatic animals are used within a massive, highly neglected commercial sector. This industry operates with very little oversight, resulting in unmitigated suffering at an astronomical scale. Our organization was founded to tackle this specific, high-volume blindspot in animal welfare through strategic, state-level policy reform.

We are a small, high-impact team. While we are still lean, we have real traction: we've passed stepping-stone legislation in one target state, triggered ongoing regulatory rulemaking in another, and prompted multiple state agencies to audit these specific supply chains. State governments are taking this issue seriously; now we need a leader to help land big, durable wins.

The Role: We are localizing our leadership to better navigate the U.S. policy landscape. Our organization was built by two co-founders; as we grow, one founder is passing over the mantle of U.S. advocacy to this role, while the other co-founder remains as a partner focused on research, operations, and long-term strategy. You will join as a core leader, initially working in close partnership with the founders to take full ownership of stakeholder relationships, advocacy campaigns, and high-level strategy.

This is a "builder" role with the responsibility and autonomy of a late-stage co-founder. This is not a job where you spend 90% of your time writing policy briefs that sit on a shelf. This is an active, outward-facing advocacy position where you will be "the face" of the effort. You will have the mandate to move the needle for millions of aquatic animals through pragmatic, bipartisan policy. We are planning a thorough onboarding process to support this transition.

What the work looks like

You'll be:

- Co-creating organizational strategy, working directly with the founders to set the long-term vision, decide which states to target next, and shape the future of the organization
- Leading meetings and phone calls with state legislators, agency staff, and key decision-makers.
- Building and managing deep relationships with local allied groups.
- Figuring out how to actually move a bill or regulation forward, unblocking political and bureaucratic hurdles as they arise.

- Collaborating with the founders to agree on outcomes and then own the execution, strategy, and relationships required to reach them.
- Acting as our primary spokesperson to increase earned media—pitching stories, writing op-eds for relevant publications, and shaping our public narrative.
- As a key part of a lean team, there will be opportunities to wear many hats; this could include absorbing broader Executive Director duties like fundraising, depending on your personal fit.

Who we're looking for

This role is likely a great fit if you:

- Want direct ownership over real-world policy outcomes
- Are energized by persuasion, relationships, and ambiguity
- Like being “the face” of an effort rather than working behind the scenes
- Have strong judgment and can be trusted with high autonomy
- Care deeply about large-scale animal impact but are pragmatic about how change actually happens
- Leverage AI and modern tools to amplify your effectiveness
- Prefer agreeing on goals over being assigned tasks
- Build trust across ideological divides and excel at bipartisan communication

Requirements:

- U.S. work authorization required (please note we are unable to sponsor employment visas)
- Remote, U.S.-based
- Deep commitment to animal impact paired with extreme pragmatism about how policy change happens.
- Proven track record of taking ownership and driving complex projects to completion (this doesn't require prior C-suite experience; leading a major campaign or high-autonomy project counts).
- Ability to travel for approximately 3 weeks per year (total), non-consecutively, for hearings, conferences, and stakeholder meetings.

Compensation:

- **Salary Range:** \$70,000 – \$100,000 USD. Final offers are commensurate with experience and adjusted based on the candidate's local cost of living. We are open to discussing compensation outside of this band for candidates bringing extensive, direct state-level policy experience.
- **Benefits:** 20 days vacation; health benefits provided through a QSEHRA reimbursement.

How to Apply

Applications will be reviewed on a rolling basis. The position will remain open until filled.

To apply, please fill out an application form [here](#). As mentioned above, our identity is temporarily withheld to protect our campaigns. We look forward to sharing our full background and specific targets with candidates who advance to the next stage of the hiring process.

If you experience technical issues with this application form or require accessibility accommodations, please reach out to: aquaticpolicysearch@gmail.com.